

When I Fall

written by

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MONTAGE

A collection of quick cut news reports, Public Service Announcements, mixed footage and social media videos starting with a report of an asteroid from outer space landing in a field in mid Idaho. Then comes a report of scientists breaking open the asteroid to reveal glowing alien crystals followed by a social media theorist discussing the presence of the crystals. The crystals get moved to a scientific lab.

A news report follows stating multiple scientists who had touched the crystals have started growing crystals on their skin. Another news report states the same scientists have grown erratic and two were missing.

The next report states that multiple individuals have reported being bitten and slashed and feelings of being lightheaded. More crystals have been spotted growing through Idaho.

Another report states one of the scientists has been caught with large crystals growing out of his body and being completely insane. He is killed by the government and we cut to two podcasters discussing the events so far. Then there's a cut to a person explaining a map with crystal sightings in multiple other states

The final few cuts are a video on social media showing an encounter with one of these crystal humans, a video from a doctor discussing the symptoms and describing the crystalization of the human brain, causing total insanity, but many symptoms are still unknown.

Finally the montage ends with a Public Service Announcement declaring a nationwide state of emergency.

CUT TO BLACK.

INT. DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Inside a dining room we see a typical American family of four: A FATHER (Mid 40s, casual, quiet) A MOTHER (Mid 40s, kind, talkative) A SISTER NAMED GIGI (8, sweet, innocent) and A BROTHER NAMED RIDER (16, typical teenage boy) all eating spaghetti and meatballs for dinner. It's a quiet, cozy setting. Before eating, they pray.

MOM

Thank you, Lord, for this food, for
our family, and for all the
blessings in our lives. Amen.

Everybody says Amen and starts eating.

MOM (CONT'D)

Did you kids hear the news? Your school's cancelled tomorrow.

GIGI

Really? How come?

MOM

The outbreak's gotten too close to our area.

RIDER

Work got cancelled too.

GIGI

How come nobody told me about this?

RIDER

We're telling you now.

MOM

You guys need to be safe out there. This virus is some crazy stuff.

RIDER

Yeah.

There's silence. Rider gets a text from his girlfriend HAILEY. It says:

COME OVER TN I'M BORED

MOM

Well anyways, just try not to be around too many people for a little. We'll be okay.

DAD

Rider, can you help me move stuff out of Joe's place tomorrow?

RIDER

Yeah.

MOM

So Gigi what'd you do at practice today?

GIGI

We got to try out the batting cages today.

MOM
Really? How'd that go?

GIGI
It was good. They even let Sarah
pitch to us.

MOM
Did you get a lot of hits?

GIGI
Yeah!

MOM
Nice.

DAD
Are you ready for your first game?

GIGI
Mm hm.

DAD
Coach say what position you're
playing?

GIGI
Third base.

DAD
Nice, nice.

Rider finishes his meal and gets up to clear his plate.

RIDER
Thanks for the dinner Mom. I gotta
go to Hailey's house real quick.

MOM
Okay, but I want you to come back
tonight. I think it's better if we
stay close.

RIDER
Sure.

Rider says bye to the rest of his family and goes out.

EXT. STREET - NIGHT

Rider leaves his house and gets in his car, a cheap bucket
for a teenager's first car, and drives off.

EXT. HAILEY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Rider hops out of his car and goes to Hailey's front yard after locking up. He looks to his left and sees a small blue crystal out of the ground in the distance.

HAILEY (16, Rider's girlfriend, sweet) opens the door and hugs him, pulling him in.

INT. HAILEY'S HOUSE - HAILEY'S ROOM - NIGHT

Rider and Hailey are making out on Hailey's bed. RNB music is playing softly in the background and the room is gently lit.

They take a break from kissing and lay on the bed together.

RIDER

Hey isn't this shit kinda crazy? I mean, crystals growing out of people? What the fuck is that?

HAILEY

Yeah, for me it's the fact they crystalize your brain and turn you into a zombie. That's fucked.

RIDER

Seriously.

HAILEY

It shouldn't last too long though, they can probably stop it before it goes international.

RIDER

COVID lasted for years.

HAILEY

I doubt this'll be like COVID. We can't have two mass pandemics in our lives.

Hailey smiles.

HAILEY (CONT'D)

One's enough.

Rider smiles and they kiss again and start making out.

The RNB music gradually gets louder as the camera pans outside through the window.

EXT. STREET - NIGHT

The RNB music plays into the scene as a man stumbles into the street outside bleeding and with small blue crystals poking out of his skin. The music goes quiet as his body twitches and he stumbles out of frame.

INT. HAILEY'S HOUSE - HAILEY'S ROOM - MORNING

Rider wakes up beside Hailey. He checks his phone to see two missed calls and a voicemail from his mom. He plays it.

MOM (VOICEMAIL)

Hey Rider, I wish you'd come home but whatever. Can you get Gigi a bag of candy when you come back? She's been bugging me all night but I'll let you deal with it. Anyways, love you. I'll see you later. Oh, yeah, and if you're gonna use my car fill it up with gas! Okay? Okay, love you. Bye.

It hangs up. Rider gently wakes up Hailey.

RIDER

Hey, I gotta go.

HAILEY

(Sleepy)

Okay.

RIDER

Love you.

HAILEY

You too.

Hailey closes her eyes and Rider kisses her forehead. He gets up and heads out.

EXT. RIDER'S HOUSE - MORNING

Rider pulls up to his house and sees a broken window. Puzzled, he investigates it and heads through his backyard.

In the backyard there is a broken sliding glass door.

RIDER

Hello? Is there anybody there?

There's no answer. Rider walks into the house and calls out again.

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - MORNING

There's no answer. He sees blood on the floor and then he sees his mom on the floor face-down.

RIDER

Mom?

Rider cautiously approaches his mom and sees her neck ripped up. His mom twitches suddenly and lunges at Rider from the ground. She's a zombie now and has small blue crystals poking out of her face.

Rider starts crying in fear and runs away. He makes his way to his sister's room and opens the door to see his zombified sister staring at him on the floor.

RIDER (CONT'D)

No, no, no, no..

Rider yells in fear and backs up against the wall. He starts yelling for help.

CUT TO BLACK.

A phone rings and an officer answers.

OFFICER (V.O.)

Hello?

(pause)

I understand, please vacate the house and find a safe area but try to keep an eye on the infected. Help is on the way.

INT. RIDER'S CAR - MORNING

Rider is sitting in his car traumatized, unable to focus on anything, dried tears. He sees 3 cars pull up to his house with government officials exiting from them. One OFFICER knocks on his window.

EXT. RIDER'S HOUSE - MORNING

Rider gets out of the car and sinks to the ground, completely devastated. Some neighbors are outside of their houses, confused.

OFFICER
I'm sorry this had to happen son. I
truly am.

Rider doesn't say anything.

OFFICER (CONT'D)
We're gonna have to ask you
questions, of course.

RIDER
I- I just don't want to be talked
to right now.

OFFICER
I understand, but-

Rider doesn't say anything again.

OFFICER (CONT'D)
Later then. But I come with worse
news unfortunately.

The officer looks at Rider's house.

OFFICER (CONT'D)
We're- we're

The officer puts his head down.

OFFICER (CONT'D)
I'm sorry. We have to- For the
safety of everybody else. We-

RIDER
There's gotta be a cure right?
Experimental? You can't do that.

Rider sees a few armed soldiers enter his house. He screams
and begs, flailing around but the officer secures him and
hugs him.

RIDER (CONT'D)
(Screaming)
No!! Let me go!

Rider sobs into the officer's arms.

OFFICER
Come on, let's get in.

INT. OFFICER'S CAR - MORNING

Rider gets laid into the backseat curled up and crying. The officer starts driving and gets another call.

REPORT (RADIO)

There's been another report of
alleged infection in South San
Diego.

RIDER (TO OFFICER)

Please sir, don't let my sister
die. Please do something.

OFFICER

There's nothing I can do kid. I'm
sorry.

The radio turns back on.

REPORT (RADIO)

There's been two reported sightings
of infected persons in Bankers
Hill.

Rider looks out the window and hears gunshots from inside his house. He yells and presses his face against the window. He cries against the window as the car keeps driving away from the house.

The officer keeps driving without talking though hes clearly mournful. Reports keep coming in every couple of seconds and a little later an infected person with orange crystals is stumbling across the street.

OFFICER

Jesus.
(to Rider)
Just stay here, okay?

The officer gets out of the car.

EXT. STREET - MORNING

The officer gets out of his car and draws his handgun on the infected. He aims it, then nervously closes his eyes to shoot it. He sheds a tear and gets back to his car.

OFFICER

Infected down in Downtown.

INT. OFFICER'S CAR - MORNING

The officer gets back in the car and starts driving again, taking a deep breath. Rider is slumped against the window, staring outside. A new report radios in about another infected spotting. After a couple seconds of silence, the officer speaks up.

OFFICER

I- never just killed a civilian
like that. I don't even know.

Rider stays silent.

OFFICER (CONT'D)

But that's our orders you know.
Shoot on site. It's hard to
believe.

(pause)

It's easier to close your eyes.

RIDER

Where are you taking me?

OFFICER

A newly built safe zone. The
disease is hitting us hard all
across the city.

(pause)

What's your name? If you don't mind
me asking.

RIDER

Rider.

OFFICER

I'm Mark.

They keep driving in silence as another report radios in.

EXT. SAFE ZONE - MORNING

Officer Mark helps Rider out of the car and out into the safe zone, where they push through a crowd of people waiting in line and through a security checkpoint. Rider is tested by people in lab coats and is verified, making it past the checkpoint.

Mark guides Rider to a FEMALE VOLUNTEER (30s).

MARK

Alright, I've gotta go back out there but this woman will help you with everything you need. There's clothes, food, beds, all you need. Okay?

Rider nods and hugs Mark. He cries on Mark's shoulder.

MARK (CONT'D)

You're gonna be okay.

Mark goes back out the checkpoint and Rider goes with the woman.

INT. WELLNESS ROOM - LATER

Rider is sitting in a large room full of beds and refugees. He is laying on a bed replaying the voicemail his mom left him.

The door to the room opens and Hailey comes in. Rider is shocked as Hailey heads over to him crying. Rider stands up and they hug.

HAILEY

Oh my god Rider, I'm so sorry.

They hug for a while then Hailey sits on the bed. She starts crying again which causes Rider to cry again and they hug.

HAILEY (CONT'D)

I don't know what to do.

RIDER

Just stay here for a while.

HAILEY

Rider, my family's leaving. We have family in Texas, and the virus hasn't hit there yet.

RIDER

What?

HAILEY

I think I can convince my parents to take you too. Come with me.

RIDER

Hailey, I don't think I'm gonna make it.

HAILEY

What do you mean?

RIDER

My whole family's gone. I can't go on living. Everything's fucked up.

HAILEY

No Rider. No, no that's not, don't say that.

As Rider talks he starts to break down.

RIDER

I have to stay here but I can't live with it much longer. I was supposed to come home that night and I probably would've got home late enough to stop the zombies from getting in. I would've been awake.

HAILEY

No, we don't know that. You could've died too. Look, I'll come back to visit you as soon as it's safe. Stay alive, for me. Okay?

RIDER

(sullenly)

Okay.

HAILEY

You really do have so much time left. Things'll get better, just not for a while. But they will get better.

(pause)

Hey, look at me.

Hailey lifts Rider's head and looks in his eyes.

HAILEY (CONT'D)

Promise me you won't kill yourself.

RIDER

Promise you'll come back for me then.

HAILEY

I will. I promise.

RIDER

Ok.

INT. WELLNESS ROOM - DAY

Rider is sitting at a table in the wellness room for lunchtime alone. There are some people around the room talking to each other. Rider hasn't touched his food.

Officer Mark comes into the room and sits with Rider. He has a cup of coffee.

MARK

Hey.

RIDER

Hi.

MARK

You doing better?

RIDER

A little.

MARK

Good, good.

Mark notices that Rider isn't eating.

MARK (CONT'D)

You should eat when you can. It's not good to starve yourself.

RIDER

Maybe tomorrow.

MARK

That would be good. Take care of yourself okay?

Rider nods.

EXT. ROOF - SUNSET

Rider and Mark walk up onto the roof of a building overlooking the checkpoint. There are multiple smoke signals and occasional gunshots in the background. A couple people are also watching, sitting and talking.

MARK

Jesus, this is unbelievable.

RIDER

Yeah.

MARK
Do you need anything?

RIDER
No.

MARK
Alright.

They go to some seats and sit down together.

INT. WELLNESS ROOM - NIGHT

The lights are out and everybody is in their beds. Rider sits alone staring emptily at the floor.

Visions pop into the head of his dead family and he puts his hand on his forehead.

INT. WELLNESS ROOM - DAY

Rider is eating his food and looks exhausted. Mark comes in again.

MARK
You look exhausted.

RIDER
I can't sleep that much.

MARK
You want coffee?

Rider nods and Mark hands him his cup. Rider takes some sips and offers it. Mark shakes his head no.

MARK (CONT'D)
I'm glad you're eating.

RIDER
I'm leaving today.

MARK
Why?

RIDER
I have to go home for a little bit.

MARK
Are you sure? It's not safe over there.

RIDER
Yeah, I have to.

MARK
Okay. Then you're coming back?

RIDER
I don't think so. I don't really
like it here.

MARK
I don't think you should go. I'll
head up for you.

RIDER
You're not my fucking dad. I'm
going.

MARK
Let me come with you then.

RIDER
No.

MARK
How are you gonna get there without
a car?

Rider sighs.

INT. MARK'S CAR - DAY

Rider and Mark are driving together. They look out the window
to see zombies everywhere. Mark hands Rider a gun.

MARK
Just watch out.

They pass government agents with bodies lined up in rows
being burnt. The agents are heavily armed and stare down the
car but Mark and Rider keep driving.

EXT. TOWN - DAY

Mark and Rider arrive at the edge of the town. There are
bodies everywhere and an intense dread in the atmosphere and
some crystals scattered around. Rider sheds a tear.

EXT. RIDER'S HOUSE - DAY

Rider and Mark arrive outside Rider's house. They both get out of the car and walk up to the front door. The house has a DO NOT ENTER sign in the lawn with many other houses having them too. Rider cuts in front of Mark.

RIDER
Wait outside.

MARK
Sure?

RIDER
Yeah.

Mark takes a step back as Rider goes in.

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Rider steps into his house. The lights are out and the sun is shining in from the blinds. He sees four body bags laying side by side on the floor. It's his family.

Rider looks at the bodies, too many emotions in his head. He just stares for a while, contemplating. Then he pulls out a KNIFE and presses it to his arm.

EXT. RIDER'S HOUSE - DAY

Mark is waiting patiently outside and sees a VIOLET CRYSTAL ZOMBIE, a man still somewhat human, but clearly gone. It starts running towards Mark, followed by a horde of 30 or so zombies with variations of crystal colors.

Mark goes into his trunk and grabs his shotgun. He fires off a few rounds as the zombies get closer before running in the house.

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Mark locks the door and sees Rider sitting against the wall with blood streaming down his arms.

MARK
Rider..

Mark runs into the bathroom and comes out with bandages. He patches Rider's wounds who snaps out of his haze, clearly confused. Mark radios in for help.

MARK (CONT'D)
I'm gonna get us out of here.
You'll be okay.

RIDER
I came to bury them. But I guess I
forgot.. how it is.

MARK
I can do it.

Rider nods.

EXT. RIDER'S HOUSE - BACKYARD - DUSK

Mark has three holes dug in the backyard and is burying
Rider's mom. His dad and sister are already in their graves.

As he carries the body to the final grave, a crystal poking
out of the mom's head is poking out of the body bag as well
and rubs against Mark's wrist. He just wipes it off and puts
her in the grave.

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DUSK

Rider looks out the window. The zombies are gone now. Mark
comes back in after finishing the burial.

RIDER
I'm gonna stay here. I'm moving
into a house down the street.

MARK
We should go back, Rider. This
isn't a good place.

RIDER
I just need a couple weeks here.
Then we can go back. Or you could
right now if you want.

MARK
I'll stay.

RIDER
Thank you, seriously.

EXT. STREET - DUSK

Mark and Rider get back in the car.

INT. MARK'S CAR - DUSK

Mark and Rider are driving and Mark notices a weird feeling. Rider's looking out the window as Mark pulls up his sleeve to see a nasty rash forming.

EXT. NEW HOUSE - DUSK

Rider gets out of the car with Mark outside a pretty nice house.

RIDER

What do you think? Could we live here for a little?

MARK

Yeah, but I actually can't stay. I have to go back to San Diego.

Rider is surprised by Mark's sudden switch up, but doesn't know what's happening yet.

RIDER

Oh..

MARK

Are you sure you can survive out here? I'll have someone come up.

RIDER

Why are you leaving?

MARK

I gotta get back to work. You know.

RIDER

Oh, okay. Right.

(beat)

Okay, trust me. I'll take care of myself. I'll be back to San Diego in a few weeks to see you.

Mark painfully nods. He goes in his car and hands Rider his coffee mug.

MARK

Uh, take this.

Mark gives Rider a smile.

RIDER

Okay?

Mark takes his shotgun off his back and drapes it over Rider's shoulder.

MARK

And this.

Then he gives Rider a walkie talkie.

MARK (CONT'D)

Keep this with you.

Mark goes back to get in his car.

MARK (SHAKILY) (CONT'D)

Rider, I.. I need you to take care of yourself okay?

RIDER

Yeah.

Mark nods and gets back in his car.

RIDER (CONT'D)

Bye!

MARK

Bye!

Rider goes into his new house and Mark starts his car.

INT. NEW HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DUSK

Rider looks around his new house then looks outside his window. Mark's still in the street, just sitting in silence. Rider knows something's up.

Mark drives off.

INT. NEW HOUSE - BEDROOM - NIGHT

Rider is laying in his bed looking up at the ceiling. The walkie talkie buzzes.

VOICE (WALKIE)

Rider Williams?

Rider sits up and talks into the walkie.

RIDER

Here.

VOICE

This is Officer Barnes of the San Diego Police Department. Mark Beckett told us to contact you.

RIDER

Oh yeah, what is it?

VOICE

Officer Beckett killed himself after dropping you off and wants us to pick you up.

Rider's eyes widen. He is in disbelief and hysteria.

VOICE (CONT'D)

He contacted a crystal out there and ended his life to avoid infection. He messaged us before he did so. We're sending a rescue team up there.

RIDER

No.. let me stay. I don't wanna go back.

VOICE

Are you sure?

RIDER

Yes, yes.

VOICE

It's not recommended.

RIDER

I know.

VOICE

If you ever need assistance, radio us. Stay safe.

Rider tosses the radio aside and stares at the wall.

CUT TO BLACK.

SUPER: 4 YEARS LATER

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - MORNING

A now 20 year old Rider wakes up from his bed in a new empty house. He gets dressed, puts Mark's handgun in his waist, and puts a black crystal necklace around his neck.

EXT. STREET - MORNING

Rider walks out of the house to a ruined empty ghost town, nearly unrecognizable from before. He's living in a different house, a fancy house with a reinforced gate. Crystals of different colors are frequent around the town.

He hops the gate then casually walks to his car, a nice fancy car (preferably a Porsche) and gets in.

INT. RIDER'S CAR - MORNING

Rider gets in the car and looks in the rear-view mirror. He sees a blue crystal zombie distantly straggling in the background. In his car there's a shotgun, duffel bag, basketball and axe in the backseat. He drives off.

EXT. ABANDONED HOUSE - MORNING

Rider pulls into the driveway of an abandoned house. He gets the shotgun and duffel bag out of his backseat and goes in the house.

INT. ABANDONED HOUSE - MORNING

Rider enters the abandoned house with his shotgun drawn. He explores the house for a little before finding a liquor cabinet. He takes several bottles and puts them in the bag.

Then he gets upstairs and opens the door to a room. It's a little kid's room, full of toys that haven't been touched in years.

He goes into the master bedroom next and goes through the drawers. He sees money and grabs it then heads down to the garage.

INT. ABANDONED HOUSE - GARAGE - MORNING

Rider gets in the garage and is scared by a rat. He finds a box of canned food and checks their expiration dates, putting some in the bag. He then manages to find some blu-ray movies in a box that he dumps into his bag. Rider laughs.

RIDER
What the fuck?

EXT. ABANDONED HOUSE - MORNING

The garage door opens and Rider comes out with his bag. A green crystal zombie walks in a close vicinity to him so Rider aims his shotgun and shoots the zombie.

He gets back in his car and drives off. The zombie gets back up and slightly heals, struggling about.

EXT. PARK - DAY

Rider drives to a park with a basketball court. There's three blue crystal zombies straggling about. Rider hops out the car with the basketball.

He pulls out his gun and kills all three zombies then starts to play basketball.

We see a TIME LAPSE as Rider plays basketball until dusk. He gets back in his car and drives off.

EXT. RIDER'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Rider gets back to his house and hops the fence again with his duffel bag. He goes around the back of the house where there's two generators and he turns them on.

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Rider gets into his house and goes to his pantry. It's full of canned foods.

Right next to that is the liquor cabinet filled with all kinds of alcohol. He puts all the alcohol away except for a bottle of Hennessy that he takes with him.

He goes to the kitchen and opens a cooler with a couple soft drinks in it. He grabs a coke and makes himself a drink.

After that he makes a quick peanut butter and jelly sandwich. Then he puts a CD into a CD player connected to a projector in his living room as he sits on the couch alone.

He watches a movie while eating and drinking. He gets frustrated and gets up to grab the Hennessy again. He looks into the bottle and downs a big gulp, then another, then another.

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - MORNING

Rider wakes up hungover on the couch. The projector is just displaying no signal. Rider stumbles over to a radio and talks into it.

RIDER

Hello, is anybody there? It's
Rider, requesting a delivery.

A few seconds pass with no answer. Rider closes his eyes and sighs.

RADIO

Rider, it's Joe. What would you
like to request this time?

RIDER

A hundred gallons of gas, a box of
soda, a box of chocolate bars, and
shit,

(pause)

Uh, 5 pounds of chicken, 3 pounds
of ground beef, 3 pounds of steak,
10 pounds of assorted vegetables,
10 pounds of assorted fruit, 5
loafs of sourdough bread, 5 boxes
of pasta, 5 boxes of mac and
cheese, 5 cans of pasta sauce, 2
cartons of eggs and like 3 pounds
of salmon.

RADIO

Are you sure? That's an expensive
delivery.

RIDER

Yeah man it's fine. I hit some
houses recently.

RADIO

That's \$9,000.

RIDER

Alright.

RADIO

Rider, how have you been holdin' up
since the power and internet got
disabled?

RIDER

Just living on generators.

RADIO

There's room in San Diego. It's a lot better than how you're doing right now.

RIDER

I already said I'm staying here. There's nothing for me in that big city. This has always been my home.

RADIO

I get it, but it's gonna get harder over there. We got electricity and internet.

RIDER

That's nice for you, but I'm okay.

RADIO

Your delivery should be there tomorrow.

RIDER

Alright, thanks.

RADIO

Take care.

Rider gets off the radio and lays back down again.

EXT. RIDER'S HOUSE - MORNING

Rider hops the fence to his house again, this time not as smooth. Still, he gets to his car and drives off.

INT. ABANDONED HOUSE - DAY

Rider goes into another deserted house wielding his shotgun. He looks around to see a confederate flag and other white trash decor.

He walks around to see a locked door.

INT. RIDER'S CAR - DAY

Rider grabs the axe from his car.

INT. ABANDONED HOUSE - DAY

Rider uses the axe to chop through the locked door, and makes his way into the room. He sees a safe, an expensive scoped assault rifle, and multiple filled magazines for the gun.

Rider hits the safe with his axe multiple times, grunting and yelling until finally the safe breaks open.

A couple thousand dollars are in the safe as Rider, sweaty and tired, grabs it and the assault rifle, and heads out.

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - DAY

Rider gets to his room and tosses all his stuff aside.

EXT. STREET - MORNING

A close up on the empty Hennessy bottle Rider had been drinking. It suddenly explodes as we see Rider was using it as target practice for his new rifle. He's laying on the roof shooting things.

He looks to his right and sees a green crystal zombie in the distance. He aims and fires, but misses. He fires and misses again. Finally on the third shot we see a little pop and the zombie goes down before getting up again.

He looks to his left and sees the supply truck incoming. He stands up and puts his gun away as the truck nears his home.

He makes his way down and waits for the truck to get to his driveway. First a heavily armed soldier hops out of the passenger seat, then JOE (Guy from radio, 40s, old fashioned) gets out of the driver's seat followed by 2 young men in the backseat.

Rider manually pushes part of the gate open and steps out to greet Joe.

JOE
How are ya Rider?

RIDER
Hanging in there, I guess.

Joe looks around the desolate area.

JOE
You get lonely out here? You always make it sound like paradise but to me it's just an empty desert.

RIDER

I get lonely most days but it's nice, I don't mind. Money can be easy to come by, and though the zombies don't bother me much, there's still enough to kill. It's quiet too.

JOE

Yeah, until ya get a damn cult or Nazi group to pass by. We don't got them in San Diego.

RIDER

They don't come around too often and I've never been around them face to face.

JOE

Well we'll get ya stuff dropped off and let you have the town to yourself. Where's the money?

RIDER

Oh, I gotta grab it. I'll be back.

Rider heads into the house as Joe looks around again. He shakes his head and lights up a cigarette.

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - MORNING

Rider is counting the money on his bed. He gets the \$9000 and heads back out.

EXT. RIDER'S HOUSE - MORNING

Rider comes out and gives Joe the money. He goes in the car and starts putting it in a money counting machine.

RIDER

You got a money counter in your car? That's impressive.

JOE

They just put 'em in all the trucks. It makes our job easier.

RIDER

Yeah, but you guys upped your prices.

JOE

You ain't heard? A new wave of reds and violets hit the area so trips are more dangerous. 1 in 5 trucks don't make it home.

RIDER

Damn, I didn't hear that.

JOE

I mean, it's God's miracle I'm still here.

RIDER

You still believe in God?

JOE

Yeah. And you should.

RIDER

Nah. God wouldn't let the world get to this point.

The counter finishes counting the money. Joe waves the two young men who start grabbing supplies and bringing them into the house.

JOE

Plus those Liberty Boys rob and kill us all the time. Shit's dangerous.

A TIME LAPSE occurs as all the guys except the armed guard bring things from the supply truck to the house until it gets dark.

EXT. RIDER'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Rider is having a beer with Joe and the other guys sitting in lawn chairs outside.

JOE

You know, I see why you like it out here sometimes.

RIDER

Yeah.

JOE

But you need a woman in your life.

Joe chuckles.

RIDER

I had one, back before the
apocalypse.

JOE

She turn?

RIDER

Nah, not that I know. She went to
Texas with her family. She said she
was gonna come back for me, then
never did.

JOE

That's rough.

RIDER

I still wonder why she never came
back. It doesn't make sense.

JOE

You never went looking for her?

RIDER

Once, two years ago. I made it to
New Mexico, but there's a lot of
zombies and crazies out there.

JOE

Sure.

RIDER

I just think she's dead by now. She
would've come back.

The armed guard sees a green crystal zombie approaching in
the distance and calls out before shooting them down. The
zombie tries to get up but the guard empties the rest of the
clip into the zombie's head. It doesn't get up this time.

JOE

You gotta come visit San Diego one
day. It couldn't hurt.

RIDER

Maybe one day.

Joe checks his watch.

JOE

Well, we gotta head back. See ya
Rider, assuming I make it.
(grin)

RIDER
Safe travels.

Joe pats Rider on the back then the guys get back in the truck and drive off. Rider is alone again.

Rider reaches in his jean pocket and pulls out a photo of his family. He puts his head down for a second.

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - LATE NIGHT

Rider is sleeping deep in the night when we hear engines, yells of glory, and gunshots outside.

This wakes Rider up and he looks through his window. Through the window we can slightly see a group of white men driving 4 wheelers and motorcycles yelling and some shooting guns into the air.

These are the Liberty Boys, a white supremacist post apocalyptic group that goes around murdering people.

They drive off into the town out of sight. Rider pulls his big gun out of the closet and sets it on his bedside table before going back to bed.

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - MORNING

With his new ingredients and generator working Rider is making himself steak and eggs. Sometimes in the distance we hear gunshots from the Liberty Boys.

Rider pours some alcohol to accompany his breakfast.

EXT. RIDER'S HOUSE - MORNING

Rider looks around, then hops the fence and ducks into the neighborhood.

EXT. BUILDING - DAY

Rider climbs up to the roof of a tall building and manages to spot the Liberty Boys' camp from the distance. He looks through his scope and sees heavily armed people.

He moves the scope around and sees a horde of zombies migrating North of town.

He moves the scope a little to the right and sees a small marijuana farm.

EXT. TOWN - SUNRISE

A car drives into town.

INT. CAR - SUNRISE

A GIRL (AALIYAH, 19, mixed, relaxed) and her FATHER (RANDY, 68, black, old school) are in the car. Aaliyah is driving and they're playing RNB. There's a black crystal hanging from a string on the rear-view mirror.

AALIYAH
But out of all the places in Italy,
which place was your favorite?

RANDY
Man, I'd say Milan.

AALIYAH
God, I would love to go to Milan.

RANDY
It's beautiful.

AALIYAH
Hopefully one day.

They pass a park.

RANDY
This was the park the east-side
kids hung at. Me and your uncle
fought a couple of those guys here.

Randy chuckles and continues to look around.

RANDY (CONT'D)
Turn right here.

AALIYAH
Okay.

INT. RIDER'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - MORNING

Rider is going through pictures of his family in a photo book. He has a deep sad look on his face and looks at a particular photo of him smiling with his sister as kids.

INT. AALIYAH'S CAR - MORNING

Aaliyah and Randy arrive in Randy's old cul-de-sac. There's a somewhat high density of zombies in the area. Mostly blue and green crystal zombies with a red crystal zombie as well as a yellow crystal one.

AALIYAH
What should we do?

RANDY
Let's get out here. We're gonna
have to hurry to the house.

AALIYAH
Just get out now?

RANDY
Yeah, these guys can't be that
fast.

AALIYAH
What about our stuff?

RANDY
Just come back for it! They ain't
gonna take it.

Aaliyah parks the car and opens the door.

EXT. AALIYAH'S CAR - MORNING

Aaliyah gets out and runs to the other side to help her dad out of the car. The zombies notice them and start walking slowly.

Aaliyah runs to the trunk to get her dad's cane and then the yellow and red crystal zombies start sprinting towards the car.

RANDY
Oh lord!

Aaliyah looks and reaches into the trunk.

RANDY (CONT'D)
Aaliyah, run!

Randy gets back in the car.